LINVUU COLLECTION VOLUME 1



Olá

Portuguese

Practical grammar, from zero to A2

Volume 1 · Level A1 – A2

Linvuu

Contents

LESSON 1 **Sounds and spelling: how to read Portuguese out loud** 2

1.1 A scene you will live 2
1.2 The good news: you already know more than you think 2
1.3 How to read the pronunciation guides in this book 3
1.4 The alphabet and the letter names 3
1.5 The oral vowels 4
1.6 Nasal vowels: the sound English does not have 5
1.7 Diphthongs: two vowels in one syllable 6
1.8 The consonants 7
1.9 The Portuguese R 8
1.10 Stress: which syllable is strong 8
1.11 What each mark does 9
1.12 The survival phrases 9
1.13 Read a real text 10
1.14 The mistakes English speakers make 10
1.15 Practice 11
1.16 Pocket summary: Lesson 1 13
1.17 What comes next 13

LESSON 1

Sounds and spelling: how to read Portuguese out loud

By the end of this lesson you can read any Portuguese word aloud and be understood, spell your name with the Portuguese letter names, put the stress on the right syllable, and say the polite phrases you will use every day in Brazil.

1.1 A scene you will live

You walk into a padaria in São Paulo at 7 a.m. The woman behind the counter says, very fast: **Bom dia! Tudo bem? O que vai ser?** You understand almost nothing, and you panic. Then she points at the coffee machine, and you hear yourself say **Um café, por favor**. She smiles. **Pra viagem?** You nod. You have just had your first conversation in Portuguese.

Everything in this lesson exists to make that moment calm instead of frightening. Not grammar yet, not vocabulary yet: **sound**. If your mouth knows the sounds, every word you learn afterwards arrives already pronounceable. If it does not, every word is a small struggle.

1.2 The good news: you already know more than you think

Look at these words. You can already read most of them, and Brazilians use them every day:

ENGLISH	PORTUGUESE	HOW IT SOUNDS
chocolate	**chocolate**	sho-ko-LAH-tchee
hotel	**hotel**	oh-TEH-oo
banana	**banana**	bah-NAH-nah
family	**família**	fah-MEE-lyah
important	**importante**	eem-por-TAH~-tchee
restaurant	**restaurante**	heh-stow-RAH~-tchee
animal	**animal**	ah-nee-MAH-oo
nation	**nação**	nah-SOW~

Thousands of English words come from Latin, and so does Portuguese, so you start with a huge vocabulary. The words look familiar; the **sounds** are different. That is exactly what this lesson fixes.

The second piece of good news is that Portuguese spelling is far more regular than English. English has “though”, “through”, “tough” and “cough”. Portuguese has rules, and they nearly always work. Learn the rules once and you can read new words with confidence.

> TIP
>
> **The only secret of pronunciation:** listen first, then repeat out loud. Reading silently teaches your eyes, not your mouth. Every example in this book has audio in the Linvuu course at linvuu.com.br. Use it.

1.3 How to read the pronunciation guides in this book

Next to many Portuguese words you will see a guide like `bah-NAH-nah`. It is an approximation written with English sounds, so you can read it without learning a new alphabet. The rules are few:

IN THE GUIDE	MEANS	EXAMPLE
CAPITAL LETTERS	the stressed syllable (say it stronger and longer)	**obrigado** `oh-bree-GAH-doo`
`~` after a vowel	nasal vowel: air goes through the nose (Lesson 1.6)	**não** `NOW~`
`tch` and `dj`	as in *church* and *judge*	**noite** `NOY-tchee`, **dia** `DJEE-ah`
`zh`	as the *s* in *measure*	**hoje** `OH-zhee`
`sh`	as in *ship*	**xícara** `SHEE-kah-rah`
`ly`, `ny`	the Portuguese *lh* and *nh*	**filho** `FEE-lyoo`, **amanhã** `ah-mah-NYAH~`
`h`	the Brazilian *r* at the start of a word: like English *h* in *hot*	**rua** `HOO-ah`
`oo` at the end	the Portuguese final *l* or *-o*: like *oo* in *zoo*	**Brasil** `brah-ZEE-oo`

The guide is a bridge, not the destination. After a few weeks you will stop needing it. Its limits are honest ones: it cannot show the difference between the open and the closed *e* or *o* (the accent marks do that, see 1.5), and it cannot show the melody of a sentence. For those, listen.

1.4 The alphabet and the letter names

Portuguese uses the same 26 letters as English. The letters **k**, **w** and **y** are used mostly in foreign words and abbreviations (the 2009 spelling reform made them official). What changes is the **name** of each letter, and you need the names whenever someone asks you to spell something: your name at a hotel, your e-mail at a bank, your street for a delivery.

LETTER	NAME	GUIDE	EXAMPLE
A a	á	`ah`	**amigo** (friend)
B b	bê	`beh`	**bom** (good)
C c	cê	`seh`	**casa** (house)
D d	dê	`deh`	**dia** (day)
E e	é	`eh`	**escola** (school)
F f	efe	`EH-fee`	**família** (family)
G g	guê	`zheh`	**gato** (cat)
H h	agá	`ah-GAH`	**hotel** (hotel)
I i	i	`ee`	**ilha** (island)
J j	jota	`ZHOH-tah`	**janeiro** (January)
K k	cá	`kah`	**kiwi** (kiwi)

LETTER	NAME	GUIDE	EXAMPLE
L l	**ele**	EH-lee	**livro** (book)
M m	**eme**	EH~-mee	**mãe** (mother)
N n	**ene**	EH-nee	**nome** (name)
O o	**ó**	aw	**obrigado** (thank you)
P p	**pê**	peh	**pão** (bread)
Q q	**quê**	keh	**queijo** (cheese)
R r	**erre**	EH-hee	**rua** (street)
S s	**esse**	EH-see	**sol** (sun)
T t	**tê**	teh	**tarde** (afternoon)
U u	**u**	oo	**uva** (grape)
V v	**vê**	veh	**vinho** (wine)
W w	**dáblio**	DAH-blee-oo	**web** (web)
X x	**xis**	sheess	**xícara** (cup)
Y y	**ípsilon**	EEP-see-lon	**yoga** (yoga)
Z z	**zê**	zeh	**zero** (zero)

WATCH OUT

Four names trip up English speakers every time. **G** is not *gee*: it is **gê**. **J** is not *jay*: it is **jota**. **E** is not *ee*: it is **é**. **I** is not *eye*: it is **i**, like the *ee* in *see*. Say them out loud ten times; people will hear them constantly.

The letter H is silent. **Hotel** oh-TEH-oo, **hoje** OH-zhee, **homem** OH~-meh~ee. It only does something inside two digraphs: **ch** sh and **lh** ly, and **nh** ny (see 1.8).

To spell an e-mail, say **arroba** for @ and **ponto** for the dot: **ana ponto silva arroba exemplo ponto com ponto bê erre** is ana.silva@exemplo.com.br.

1.5 The oral vowels

Portuguese writes five vowel letters (a, e, i, o, u), but you hear more than five sounds, because **e** and **o** each have an open and a closed version. The vowels are **pure**: unlike English, you do not glide. English speakers say *day* as "day-ee" and *go* as "go-oo". In Portuguese, stop the sound before the glide starts.

1 Learn the five clean vowels

Keep your tongue and lips still while the sound lasts. Do not let it slide.

LETTER	SOUND	LIKE ENGLISH…	EXAMPLE
a (stressed)	open *ah*	*father*	**casa** KAH-zah, **pá** pah
e (stressed, é)	open *eh*	*bed*	**café** kah-FEH, **pé** peh
e (stressed, ê)	closed *eh*	*say*, but cut off before the glide	**você** voh-SEH, **mesa** MEH-zah
i	*ee*	*see*	**aqui** ah-KEE, **vida** VEE-dah
o (stressed, ó)	open *aw*	*thought* (US: *dog*)	**avó** ah-VAW, **pó** paw
o (stressed, ô)	closed *oh*	*go*, but cut off before the glide	**avô** ah-VOH, **povo** POH-voo
u	*oo*	*food*	**uva** OO-vah, **tudo** TOO-doo

2 **Know that the accent marks tell you open or closed**

The acute accent (´) marks a stressed vowel that is **open**: café, avó, pé. The circumflex (^) marks a stressed vowel that is **closed**: você, avô, bebê. Without a mark, you will learn the sound word by word. The difference matters because it can change the meaning: avó is *grandmother* and avô is *grandfather*.

3 **Weaken the vowels at the end of a word**

When a vowel is **unstressed and at the end of a word**, it becomes weak and short:

- final **-e** sounds like a short *ee*: noite NOY-tchee, grande GRAH~-djee, desculpe djees-KOOL-pee
- final **-o** sounds like a short *oo*: tudo TOO-doo, obrigado oh-bree-GAH-doo, livro LEE-vroo
- final **-a** is a relaxed *ah*, close to the last vowel of *sofa*: casa, pessoa peh-SOH-ah

TYPICAL MISTAKES

WRONG	RIGHT	WHY
~~oh-bree-GAH-doh~~	oh-bree-GAH-doo	in obrigado the final -o is a weak *oo*
~~NOY-teh~~	NOY-tchee	in noite the final -e is a weak *ee*, and *t* before *i* becomes *tch*
~~voh-SAY-ee~~	voh-SEH	in você there is no glide: stop the vowel cleanly
~~kah-FAY~~	kah-FEH	in café, é is an open *eh*, as in *bed*

1.6 Nasal vowels: the sound English does not have

This is the single biggest surprise for English speakers, and mastering it changes how your whole Portuguese sounds. A **nasal vowel** is a vowel pronounced with air flowing through the nose as well as the mouth. You make it by saying the vowel while thinking of the *ng* of *sing*, **without** closing your mouth on a final *n* or *m*.

English has nasal vowels only as a side effect (the vowel in *sing* or *can't* is slightly nasal), never as a sound of its own. Portuguese uses them to tell words apart, and they are among the most frequent sounds in the language.

1 **Spot the nasal signs**

Portuguese marks nasal vowels in three ways:

- a **tilde** (~) over **ã** and **õ**: mãe, pão, limões
- a vowel followed by **m** or **n** before another consonant: tempo, onde, campo, quinto, um
- a final **-m** after a vowel: bom, sim, bem, tem, um

2 **Say the vowel through the nose, and stop**

The *m* or *n* is not a separate consonant sound. It is only the sign that the vowel is nasal. Do not close your lips on bom: say BOH~ and stop.

WORD	GUIDE	MEANING
sim	SEE~	yes
bem	BEH~ee	well, fine
bom	BOH~	good
um	OO~	one, a
não	NOW~	no
pão	POW~	bread

WORD	GUIDE	MEANING
mão	MOW~	hand
mãe	MAH~ee	mother
muito	MOO~ee-too	very, a lot
limão	lee-MOW~	lemon, lime
coração	koh-rah-SOW~	heart
pensar	peh~-SAR	to think

Three endings need special attention because you will use them all the time:

- **-ão** (stressed): **pão**, **não**, **coração**. A nasal *ow*, one syllable.
- **-am** and **-em** (unstressed endings of third-person plural verbs): **falam** FAH-lah~oo ends in a short nasal *ow*; **comem** KOH-meh~ee ends in a nasal *ay*.
- **-ões** and **-ães**: the plural of words in **-ão**: **limões** lee-MOH~eess, **pães** PAH~eess.

HOW IT COMPARES

IN ENGLISH	IN PORTUGUESE
"song", "sing": the *ng* is a consonant you close with the tongue	**bom**, **sim**: no consonant at all, only a nasal vowel
nasal sound is accidental and changes no meaning	**pão** (bread) ≠ **pau** (stick); **mão** (hand) ≠ **mau** (bad); **lã** (wool) ≠ **lá** (there)

TYPICAL MISTAKES

WRONG	RIGHT	WHY
~~NOWN~~	NOW~	in **não**, do not add a clear *n* at the end
~~BOHM, with closed lips~~	BOH~	in **bom**, close with the nose, not with the lips
~~PAH-oh (two syllables)~~	POW~	**pão** is a single syllable
~~SIM, as in *simple*~~	SEE~	in **sim** the vowel is *ee*, nasal

1.7 Diphthongs: two vowels in one syllable

A **diphthong** is two vowels pronounced in a single syllable, the second one weak.
In Portuguese they are written with **i** or **u** as the second element.

WRITTEN	SOUNDS LIKE	EXAMPLE
ai	*eye*	**pai** pie (father), **mais** mice (more)
ei	*ay* (as in *day*)	**feito** FAY-too (done), **beijo** BAY-zhoo (kiss)
oi	*oy*	**oi** oy (hi), **noite** NOY-tchee
ui	*oo-ee*	**muito** MOO~ee-too, **fui** FOO-ee
au	*ow* (as in *cow*)	**causa** KOW-zah (cause), **pausa** POW-zah
eu	*eh-oo*	**meu** MEH-oo (my), **europeu** eh-oo-roh-PEH-oo
ou	usually a short *oh*	**ou** oh (or), **pouco** POH-koo (little)
iu	*ee-oo*	**viu** VEE-oo (saw)

> TIP
>
> **Ou** is written with **u**, but in everyday Brazilian speech it is nearly a plain *oh*. Do not say *ow*: **pouco** is POH-koo, never "POW-koo".

1.8 The consonants

Good news first: **b, d, f, k, m, n, p, t, v, z** sound much like English. Aim for a softer *t* and *d*, with the tongue touching the back of the upper teeth rather than the ridge behind them; do not puff air after *p*, *t* and *k*. Now the ones that need your attention.

Seven consonants that work differently

LETTER(S)	WHERE	SOUND	EXAMPLE
c	before a, o, u	hard *k*	casa KAH-zah, cor kor, cuidado kwee-DAH-doo
c	before e, i	*s*	cedo SEH-doo (early), cinco SEE~-koo (five)
ç	before a, o, u	*s*	coração, açúcar ah-SOO-kar (sugar)
g	before a, o, u	hard *g*	gato GAH-too, gosto GOHS-too
g	before e, i	*zh* (as in *measure*)	gente ZHEH~-tchee (people), gelo ZHEH-loo (ice)
gu, **qu**	before e, i	*g*, *k* (the **u** is silent)	guerra GEH-hah (war), queijo KAY-zhoo, aqui ah-KEE
qu, **gu**	before a, o	*kw*, *gw* (the **u** is pronounced)	quatro KWAH-troo (four), água AH-gwah (water)
j	always	*zh*	janeiro zhah-NAY-roo, hoje OH-zhee, jogo ZHOH-goo
s	at the start, or **ss**	*s*	sol SAW-oo, passo PAH-soo (step)
s	between vowels	*z*	casa KAH-zah, mesa MEH-zah (table), rosa HAW-zah
z	always	*z*	zero ZEH-roo, feliz feh-LEES (final **z** often sounds like *s*)
x	most words	*sh*	xícara SHEE-kah-rah, peixe PAY-shee (fish)
x	some words	*ks*	táxi TAHK-see, tóxico TAWK-see-koo
x	some words	*z*	exemplo eh-ZEH~-ploo, exame eh-ZAH-mee
ch	always	*sh*	chá shah (tea), chuva SHOO-vah (rain)

TIP

The x has four sounds: *sh* (caixa), *ks* (táxi), *z* (exemplo), *s* (próximo PRAW-see-moo). There is no rule you can apply from the spelling; learn each new word with its sound. The good news: the *sh* sound is by far the most common.

Three digraphs you will see in every sentence

WRITTEN	SOUND	EXAMPLE
lh	ly, like the *lli* in *million*	filho FEE-lyoo (son), trabalho trah-BAH-lyoo (work)
nh	ny, like the *ni* in *onion*	amanhã ah-mah-NYAH~ (tomorrow), vinho VEE-nyoo (wine)
ch	sh	chave SHAH-vee (key), chocolate

Two consonants that change at the end of a syllable

Final L sounds like *oo*. At the end of a word or before a consonant, the Portuguese **l** is no longer the English *l*. It becomes a short *oo*: Brasil brah-ZEE-oo, hotel oh-TEH-oo, total toh-TAH-oo, alto AH-oo-too (tall), sol SAW-oo. At the start of a syllable, the **l** stays a normal *l*: livro, leite LAY-tchee (milk).

T and D before *i* become *tch* and *dj*. In most of Brazil (São Paulo, Rio, Belo Horizonte, Brasília, Salvador and many other places), the letters **t** and **d** change when they come before an **i** sound. That includes the **-i** you hear in a weak final **-**

e:

WRITTEN	SOUND	EXAMPLE
ti	tchee	tio TCHEE-oo (uncle), partir par-TCHEER (to leave)
di	djee	dia DJEE-ah (day), cidade see-DAH-djee (city)
-te (final)	-tchee	noite NOY-tchee, parte PAR-tchee
-de (final)	-djee	grande GRAH~-djee, verdade ver-DAH-djee (truth)

This happens in dia, in tarde TAR-djee (afternoon) and in boa noite BOH-ah NOY-tchee, three phrases you will say today. In some regions of the Northeast and the South, people still say a plain *t* and *d*, and everyone understands both. Learn the *tch* and *dj* version; it is what most Brazilians say.

1.9 The Portuguese R

The letter **r** has several sounds, and English speakers usually make the wrong one everywhere. Forget the English *r* completely (the one with the tongue curled back). Portuguese has two main sounds:

1. **The "h" R: at the start of a word, after n, l, s, and in rr**
   This sound is a breath from the back of the throat, close to the English *h* in *hot*. In Rio it is a little rougher, in São Paulo it is softer, in the countryside of São Paulo and Minas it may be a retroflex sound, and all of them are understood.

   rua HOO-ah (street), rio HEE-oo (river), carro KAH-hoo (car), Israel ees-hah-EH-oo, honra OH~-hah (honor)

2. **The tap R: between vowels, and after a consonant inside a word**
   This is a quick flick of the tongue tip against the ridge behind the upper teeth. English makes the same sound in American *butter*, *ladder* and *better*.

   caro KAH-roo (expensive), hora OH-rah (hour), para PAH-rah, obrigado, três trehss, livro

At the **end of a word** (**falar**, **comer**, **amor**), the r varies a lot: a soft tap, an *h*, or almost nothing in fast speech. In this book, the guide writes it as a plain r and you can use any of the three. Remember the two examples that show the difference: caro KAH-roo (expensive) and carro KAH-hoo (car). One extra *r* changes the sound **and** the meaning.

1.10 Stress: which syllable is strong

In English, you must learn the stress of every word. In Portuguese, you can predict it. There are only three steps.

1. **Look for a written accent mark**
   If the word has an accent mark (´, ^, or the tilde ~ in some words), that syllable is the stressed one. The mark overrides every rule: café kah-FEH, você voh-SEH, último OOL-tchee-moo, médico MEH-djee-koo, avô ah-VOH.

2 **With no mark, look at the ending**

If the word ends in **-a, -e, -o, -as, -es, -os, -am, -em, -ens**, the stress falls on the **second-to-last** syllable: casa KAH-zah, amigo ah-MEE-goo, obrigado oh-bree-GAH-doo, tarde TAR-djee, homem OH~-meh~ee, falam FAH-lah~oo.

If the word ends in **-i, -is, -u, -us, -l, -r, -z, -im, -um, -ão, -ã**, the stress falls on the **last** syllable: falar fah-LAR, Brasil brah-ZEE-oo, feliz feh-LEES, aqui ah-KEE, jardim zhar-DJEE~ (garden), irmã eer-MAH~ (sister), coração koh-rah-SOW~.

3 **Say it with the stress**

Say the stressed syllable slightly longer and clearer; the others are lighter, and the unstressed vowels at the end of the word weaken, as you saw in 1.5.

ENDS IN	STRESS FALLS ON	EXAMPLES
-a, -e, -o, -as, -es, -os, -am, -em, -ens	the second-to-last syllable	casa, amigo, tarde, homens
-i, -is, -u, -us, -l, -r, -z, -im, -um, -ão, -ã	the last syllable	aqui, falar, papel, feliz, irmão
anything, with a written accent	the accented syllable	café, médico, ônibus, país

> **WATCH OUT**
>
> The accent mark can change the meaning. país pah-EESS (country) is not pais PIESS (parents). Está (is, from *estar*) is not esta (this, feminine). When in doubt, the written accent tells you how to say the word.

1.11 What each mark does

MARK	NAME	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	EXAMPLE
´	acento agudo	stressed syllable; on a, e, o it is also an open vowel (á é í ó ú)	café, avó, último
^	acento circunflexo	stressed syllable, closed (or slightly nasal) vowel (â ê ô)	você, avô, bebê
~	til	nasal vowel (ã õ)	mãe, pão, limões
`	acento grave	only in the contraction **à**, which you will meet in Lesson 5	à (to the)
¸	cedilha	the letter **c** sounds like *s* before a, o, u (ç)	açaí, coração

1.12 The survival phrases

You will use these in your first hour in Brazil. Say each one aloud three times.

PORTUGUESE	GUIDE	MEANING
Oi!	oy	Hi! (the everyday greeting)
Olá!	oh-LAH	Hello! (a little more formal)
Bom dia.	BOH~ DJEE-ah	Good morning.
Boa tarde.	BOH-ah TAR-djee	Good afternoon.
Boa noite.	BOH-ah NOY-tchee	Good evening / Good night.
Tudo bem?	TOO-doo BEH~ee	How are you? (literally: all well?)
Tudo bem, e você?	TOO-doo BEH~ee, ee voh-SEH	Fine, and you?
Obrigado. / Obrigada.	oh-bree-GAH-doo / oh-bree-GAH-dah	Thank you.
De nada.	djee NAH-dah	You're welcome.

PORTUGUESE	GUIDE	MEANING
Por favor.	poor fah-VOR	Please.
Com licença.	koh~ lee-SEH~-sah	Excuse me (to pass or to enter).
Desculpe. / Desculpa.	djees-KOOL-pee / djees-KOOL-pah	Sorry.
Tchau!	tchow	Bye!
Até logo.	ah-TEH LOH-goo	See you soon.

1 **Use bom dia, boa tarde and boa noite by the clock**

Bom dia until about noon, **boa tarde** from noon until it gets dark, **boa noite** after that. Notice that **dia** is masculine and takes **bom**, while **tarde** and **noite** are feminine and take **boa**. Brazilians use **boa noite** both to arrive and to leave, unlike English, which splits *good evening* and *good night*.

2 **Answer "tudo bem?" with "tudo bem"**

Tudo bem? is a greeting, not a medical question. The answer is almost always **tudo bem**, followed by **e você?**. It is the Brazilian equivalent of *how's it going?*, and nobody expects a long answer.

3 **Choose obrigado or obrigada by who is speaking**

The ending follows **you**, the speaker, not the person you are thanking. A man says **obrigado**; a woman says **obrigada**. This is the first time you meet gender agreement in Portuguese, and it will keep coming back.

1.13 Read a real text

Read the text aloud, slowly, then read it again, with the guide covered. The first time, check every stressed syllable.

> Eu sou a Marina. Moro em São Paulo, no Brasil. Hoje é domingo e a minha família vem aqui em casa. A minha mãe faz um bolo de chocolate, o meu pai prepara um café e o meu irmão traz pão. Tudo está pronto e a minha família está muito feliz.

Guide:
EH-oo SOH ah mah-REE-nah. MOH-roo eh~ee sow~ POW-loo, noo brah-ZEE-oo. OH-zhee eh doh-MEE~-goo ee ah MEE-nyah fah-MEE-lyah veh~ee ah-K

Translation: *I am Marina. I live in São Paulo, in Brazil. Today is Sunday and my family comes here to the house. My mother makes a chocolate cake, my father prepares a coffee and my brother brings bread. Everything is ready and my family is very happy.*

Look at what you can already do: you can read this paragraph with the correct sounds, even though you do not yet know the grammar behind it.

1.14 The mistakes English speakers make

TYPICAL MISTAKES

WRONG	RIGHT	WHY
~~ROO-ah, with an English *r*~~	HOO-ah	in **rua** the initial *r* is like English *h*, not a curled *r*
~~FEE-lee-oh~~	FEE-lyoo	in **filho**, **lh** is one sound, *ly*
~~brah-ZEEL~~	brah-ZEE-oo	in **Brasil** the final *l* becomes *oo*

WRONG	RIGHT	WHY
~~DEE-ah~~	DJEE-ah	in **dia**, *d* before *i* becomes *dj*
~~NOY-teh~~	NOY-tchee	in **noite**, *t* before *i* becomes *tch*, and the final *e* is a weak *ee*
~~HOH-jay~~	OH-zhee	in **hoje** the **h** is silent and **j** is *zh*
~~GEN-teh~~	ZHEH~-tchee	in **gente**, **g** before e is *zh*
~~KWAY-zhoo~~	KAY-zhoo	in **queijo** the **u** of **que** is silent
~~PAH-oh~~	POW~	**pão** is one nasal syllable
~~oh-bree-GAY-doh~~	oh-bree-GAH-doo	in **obrigado** the vowel is a pure *ah* with no glide, and the final *-o* is *oo*
~~ZEE-kah-rah~~	SHEE-kah-rah	in **xícara**, **x** is *sh*

1.15 Practice

PRACTICE · PART A: SAY THE LETTERS

1. Spell your first name aloud with the Portuguese letter names.

2. Spell **Brasil** aloud: bê, erre, á, esse, i, ele. Then spell **Portugal**.

3. Say your e-mail address aloud, with **arroba** and **ponto**.

4. Which letter name is correct for **g**? (a) *gee* (b) *zheh* © *jay*

5. Which letter is silent in **hotel**?

PRACTICE · PART B: CHOOSE THE SOUND

1. **queijo** is read: (a) KWAY-zhoo (b) KAY-zhoo © KEH-zhoo

2. **gente** is read: (a) GEN-tchee (b) JEN-tee © ZHEH~-tchee

3. **dia** is read: (a) DEE-ah (b) DJEE-ah © DAY-ah

4. **filho** is read: (a) FEE-lyoo (b) FEE-yoh © FEEL-hoo

5. **Brasil** ends with the sound: (a) *l* (b) *oo* © *r*

6. **xícara** starts with: (a) *z* (b) *ks* © *sh*

7. **rua** starts with: (a) *r* as in *red* (b) *h* as in *hot* © a tap

PRACTICE · PART C: NASAL OR NOT?

1. Which word has a nasal vowel? (a) **pau** (b) **pão**

2. Which word means *bad*? (a) **mão** (b) **mau**

3. Which word means *there*? (a) **lá** (b) **lã**

4. **sim** is read: (a) SEEM (b) SEE~

5. bom is read: (a) `BOHM` (b) `BOH~`

PRACTICE · PART D: WHERE IS THE STRESS?

For each word, choose the stressed syllable.

1. amigo: (a) a (b) mi © go

2. falar: (a) fa (b) lar

3. café: (a) ca (b) fé

4. cidade: (a) ci (b) da © de

5. médico: (a) mé (b) di © co

6. feliz: (a) fe (b) liz

7. irmão: (a) ir (b) mão

8. tarde: (a) tar (b) de

PRACTICE · PART E: SAY IT

1. Read the five phrases aloud, once with the guide and once without: Bom dia, Boa tarde, Boa noite, Tudo bem?, Obrigada.

2. Greet an imaginary neighbor three different ways: with oi, with bom dia and with boa tarde. Then thank them and say goodbye.

ANSWER KEY

1. Say each letter; compare with the table in 1.4. Check the letters that differ from English (g, j, e, i, r, x).
2. **bê, erre, á, esse, i, ele**. Portugal: **pê, ó, erre, tê, u, gê, á, ele**.
3. For example **ana ponto silva arroba exemplo ponto com**.
4. (b) **gê**, `zheh` .
5. **h**, which is always silent.
6. (b) `KAY-zhoo` : in **que** the **u** is silent.
7. © `ZHEH~-tchee` : **g** before **e** is *zh*, the vowel **e** is nasal, and **te** becomes *tchee*.
8. (b) `DJEE-ah` : **d** before **i** becomes *dj*.
9. (a) `FEE-lyoo` : **lh** is *ly*.
10. (b) *oo*: the final **l** becomes *oo*.
11. © *sh*: **x** in this word.
12. (b) *h*: the initial **r** is like English *h*.
13. (b) **pão**.
14. (b) **mau**.
15. (a) **lá**.
16. (b) `SEE~` .
17. (b) `BOH~` .
18. (b) **a-**MI**-go**: ends in **-o**, so the stress falls on the second-to-last syllable.
19. (b) **fa-**LAR****: ends in **-r**, so the last syllable.
20. (b) **ca-**FÉ****: the written accent.
21. (b) **ci-**DA****-de**: ends in **-e**, so the second-to-last syllable.
22. (a) ****MÉ****-di-co**: the written accent.
23. (b) **fe-**LIZ****: ends in **-z**, so the last syllable.
24. (b) **ir-**MÃO****: ends in **-ão**, so the last syllable.
25. (a) ****TAR****-de**: ends in **-e**, so the second-to-last syllable.
26. Check each against 1.12: `BOH~ DJEE-ah` , `BOH-ah TAR-djee` , `BOH-ah NOY-tchee` , `TOO-doo BEH~ee` , `oh-bree-GAH-dah` .
27. A model answer: **Oi, tudo bem? Bom dia! Boa tarde! Obrigado. Tchau, até logo!**

1.16 Pocket summary: Lesson 1

POCKET SUMMARY

- **Alphabet:** 26 letters; names to remember: **g** = **gê**, **j** = **jota**, **e** = **é**, **r** = **erre**, **x** = **xis**, **h** = **agá** (silent).
- **Pure vowels:** no glide. Final **-e** = weak *ee*, final **-o** = weak *oo*, final **-a** = relaxed *ah*.
- **Open and closed:** ´ marks an open vowel (**café**), ^ a closed one (**você**).
- **Nasal vowels:** **ã**, **õ**, **-m**, **-n** before a consonant. Say the vowel through the nose and stop: **bom** `BOH~`.
- **Consonants:** **c** before e, i = *s*; **ç** = *s*; **g** before e, i = **j** = *zh*; **gu/qu** before e, i: silent **u**; **lh** = *ly*; **nh** = *ny*; **ch** = **x** = *sh*; **s** between vowels = *z*.
- **R:** initial and **rr** = *h*; between vowels = tap.
- **T, D before *i*:** *tch*, *dj*: **dia**, **noite**.
- **Final L** = *oo*: **Brasil** `brah-ZEE-oo` .
- **Stress:** accent mark wins; otherwise **-a, -e, -o, -s, -m** = second-to-last; **-i, -u, -l, -r, -z, -ão** = last.
- **Politeness:** **bom dia** (masc.), **boa tarde**, **boa noite** (fem.); **obrigado** (man), **obrigada** (woman).

1.17 What comes next

In Lesson 2 you start building real sentences with **ser**, the verb for saying who you are and what things are. You will learn the subject pronouns, including the everyday **você** and **a gente**, and how adjectives agree with the person they describe.

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